

Swiss Water Monitoring

Contact Directory for Data Access & Sensor Enquiries

23 agencies · Federal · Cantonal · Research · Aggregators

August 2026

This directory lists the contact person or team for each Swiss water monitoring network, with notes on the best approach for two questions: (1) may we use your data, and (2) what sensors do you use. Contacts were verified from official agency websites in August 2026.

Purpose of this directory

- Data reuse — understand licensing, API access, and any restrictions
- Sensor technology — identify what hardware is deployed so we can make informed choices

Contact Directory

Agency	Unit / Team	Contact Name	Email	Phone	Best Approach
FEDERAL					
BAFU/FOEN	Abteilung Hydrologie — Datenservice / Abfragezentrale	Carlo Scapoza (Abteilungschef); Robert Lukes (Sektionschef ...)	hydrologie@bafu.admin.ch abfragezentrale@bafu.admin.ch	+41 58 464 71 87 (	Use the "Datenservice Hydrologie" order form; if no confirmation arrives, email hydrologie@bafu.admin.ch directly (BAFU). For API/raw-feed access ask abfragezentrale@bafu.admin.ch (hydrodata.ch)
BAFU/FOEN	NAWA (surface-water quality) — Abteilung Wasser, jointly with Abteilung Hydrol...	Christian Leu (Head of section Water quality); Patrice Eschm...	wasser@bafu.admin.ch hydrologie@bafu.admin.ch	+41 58 462 69 69 (	Email wasser@bafu.admin.ch and cc hydrologie@bafu.admin.ch; NAWA is run jointly with the cantons, so ask which cantonal partner owns each station (BAFU)
BAFU/FOEN	NAQUA (national groundwater monitoring) — Hydrogeologische Grundlagen	Flavio Malaguerra (Sektionschef Hydrogeologische Grundlagen)...	hydrogeologie@bafu.admin.ch	+41 58 464 71 87 (	Email hydrogeologie@bafu.admin.ch with the exact sites/parameters wanted; note many NAQUA stations are operated by cantons, so cantonal permission may also be needed (BAFU)
MeteoSwiss	Open Data Support (Kundendienst / Sales & Support)	n.a. (team address only)	opendata.en@meteoswiss.ch kundendienst@meteoswiss.ch	+41 58 460 99 99 (	Email Open Data Support (opendata.en@meteoswiss.ch) or use the web contact form linked from the Open Data documentation (opendatadocs.meteoswiss.ch)
Swisstopo	Datenabgabe / geodata service	Raphaël Bovier (Datenabgabe swisstopo) (admin.ch media relea...	geodata@swisstopo.ch raphael.bovier@swisstopo.ch info@swisstopo.ch	+41 58 469 01 11 (	Standard products are free OGD and need no request; email geodata@swisstopo.ch only for non-OGD, historic or unusually large datasets and for licence clarifications (swisstopo)
CANTONAL					
AWEL, Canton Zurich	Abteilung Wasserbau — Sektion Geoinformation und Hydrometrie (data/sensors); A...	Marco Walser (Sektionsleiter Geoinformation und Hydrometrie) ...	wasserbau@bd.zh.ch marco.walser@bd.zh.ch miriam.steinmann@bd.zh.ch gewaesserschutz@bd.zh.ch	+41 43 259 32 24 (	Email the named hydrometry staff directly (they run the gauging network and sensors); route water-quality/NAWA questions to gewaesserschutz@bd.zh.ch (Kanton Zürich)
AWA, Canton Bern	Amt für Wasser und Abfall (AWA)	Jean-Pierre Clément and Reto Manser listed as Gewässerschutz...	info.awa@be.ch jean-pierre.clement@be.ch reto.manser@be.ch	031 633 38 11 (	Send one email to info.awa@be.ch asking to be routed to the hydrometry / "Hydrologische Daten" desk — the AWA explicitly owns water-quality monitoring and lake outflow regulation (Kanton Bern)

Agency	Unit / Team	Contact Name	Email	Phone	Best Approach
DGE, Canton Vaud	DGE-EAU, division Ressources en eau et économie hydraulique; section Hydrologi...	Stéphanie André (cheffe de division DGE-EAU); Rafael Xavier ...	stephanie.andre@vd.ch rafael.duarte@vd.ch guy.gilliand@vd.ch florence.dapples@vd.ch info.dge@vd.ch	021 316 22 63 (	Write in French to Rafael Duarte (hydrology/gauging network) for sensors and to Stéphanie André as division head for data-reuse authorisation; copy info.dge@vd.ch (État de Vaud)
UCA, Canton Ticino	Ufficio dei corsi d'acqua (Divisione delle costruzioni)	Laurent Filippini (Capo ufficio) (Repubblica e Cantone Ticin...	n.a.	+41 91 814 26 81 (	Use the "Scrivici" form on the UCA page, addressed to Capo ufficio Laurent Filippini, in Italian; phone the secretariat first if a fast answer is needed (Ticino)
UPAAI, Canton Ticino	Ufficio della protezione delle acque e dell'approvvigionamento idrico (Divisio...	Mauro Veronesi (Capo ufficio) (Ticino)	dt-upaai@ti.ch mauro.veronesi@ti.ch	+41 91 814 28 19 (	Email dt-upaai@ti.ch (Italian) for the office, cc mauro.veronesi@ti.ch; OASI is the public data portal, so mention which OASI series you want to reuse (KVU)
Canton Aargau	Abteilung für Umwelt (AfU), Departement Bau, Verkehr und Umwelt — sections inc...	Martin Märki (Fachbereichsleiter Gewässerschutz); Christoph ...	umwelt@ag.ch martin.maerki@ag.ch christoph.mahr@ag.ch	062 835 33 60 (	Email umwelt@ag.ch with a copy to Martin Märki; the department's own page directs enquiries through the staff directory rather than named web contacts (Kanton Aargau)
uwe, Canton Luzern	Dienststelle Umwelt und Energie — Abteilung Gewässer und Boden, Bereich Oberfl...	Robert Lovas (Hydrometrie, Seesanie rung); Ursula Leuenberger...	uwe@lu.ch	041 228 60 60 (	Two named people cover exactly the two questions: Robert Lovas for hydrometry/sensors and Ursula Leuenberger for data holdings — phone them, or use the uwe web form naming them (Kanton Luzern)
Canton Thurgau	Amt für Umwelt — Abteilung Wasserbau und Hydrometrie; Abteilung Gewässerqualit...	Philemon Diggelmann (Leiter Wasserbau und Hydrometrie); Robe...	umwelt.afu@tg.ch philemon.diggelmann@tg.ch heinz.ehmann@tg.ch	058 345 51 51 (	Email Philemon Diggelmann for the gauging network/sensors and Heinz Ehmann for water-quality data; the canton already publishes on data.tg.ch, so frame it as a reuse-licence confirmation (Kanton Thu...
AUE, Canton Basel-Stadt	Amt für Umwelt und Energie — Abteilung Gewässer und Boden (Fachstelle Oberfläc...	Markus Sommer (Stv. Abteilungsleiter; Fachstellenleiter Ober...	markus.sommer@bs.ch paul.svoboda@bs.ch juerg.schulze@bs.ch aue@bs.ch	+41 61 267 08 41 (	Email Markus Sommer directly — the AUE publishes a full staff table with topic responsibilities, and Rhine surface-water monitoring sits in his Fachstelle (Kanton Basel-Stadt)

Agency	Unit / Team	Contact Name	Email	Phone	Best Approach
Canton Geneva	Office cantonal de l'eau (OCEau) — Service de la surveillance et de la protect...	Guillaume Pierrehumbert (Directeur général, OCEau) (État de ...	eau@etat.ge.ch	+41 22 388 80 60 (	Email eau@etat.ge.ch in French, addressed to the SSPMA, and ask to be forwarded to the surveillance/monitoring unit; reference SITG for the geodata side (État de Genève)
RESEARCH					
Eawag	Urban Water Observatory (UWO), Department Urban Water Management (SWW), with E...	Dr. Frank Blumensaat (senior researcher, UWO monitoring/mode...	frank.blumensaat@eawag.ch christian.ebi@eawag.ch	+41 58 765 5992 (	Email Frank Blumensaat about the network, data-sharing and publications, and Christian Ebi about the actual sensor hardware and LoRa telemetry; both are named in the UWO technical literature (UWO Lo...
Eawag	Datalakes data platform (with SDSC, EPFL, ETH Zurich)	James Runnalls (lead developer, web application/data portal)...	james.runnalls@eawag.ch damien.bouffard@eawag.ch	+41 58 765 5589 (	The portal itself states the split: technical/API questions to James Runnalls, project and collaboration/data-reuse questions to Damien Bouffard (Datalakes)
Eawag	Aquascope (underwater plankton imaging, Greifensee/Lake Zug)	Prof. Francesco Pomati (PI of Aquascope); Christian Ebi (sen...	francesco.pomati@eawag.ch christian.ebi@eawag.ch firstname.lastname@eawag.ch medien@eawag.ch	+41 58 765 5992 (	No email is published on aquascope.ch, so write to Francesco Pomati as PI (named on the Datalakes project list) and cc Christian Ebi for hardware; Aquascope data are also distributed through Datalak...
WSL	NADUF / NAWA FRACHT collaboration (FOEN + Eawag + WSL); WSL operates the Alpta...	Named WSL data contacts for the Alptal catchments: Luzi Bern...	wslinfo@wsl.ch firstname.lastname@wsl.ch hydrologie@bafu.admin.ch	+41 44 739 21 11 (	For the national programme write to BAFU (hydrologie@bafu.admin.ch); for the WSL-operated Alptal stations the WSL page says to ask the responsible researchers directly — email Luzi Bernhard / Patric...
LéXPLORE (EPFL/Eawag/UNIL/UNIGE)	Managed by the EPFL Limnology Center (LIMNC) (lexplore.info)	Dr. Natacha Tofield-Pasche (Operational Director, Limnology ...	natacha.tofield-pasche@epfl.ch alfred.wueest@epfl.ch	+41 21 693 5943 (	The website publishes no address, so email Natacha Tofield-Pasche directly — she manages platform operations, the core/background dataset and project access (EPFL people, lexplore.info). Eawag co-le...
AGGREGATORS					

Agency	Unit / Team	Contact Name	Email	Phone	Best Approach
api.existenz.ch	Bureau für digitale Existenz (one-person operation)	Christian Studer (creator/operator of the APIs) (api.existen...	cstuder@existenz.ch	n.a.	Email Christian Studer directly; the site invites feedback and help requests at that address. Remember his APIs re-serve BAFU and MeteoSwiss data, which must be credited and linked back to BAFU — so...
opendata.swiss	Operated by the federal administration; the published contact routes to the Fe...	n.a. (team address only)	opendata@bfs.admin.ch	n.a.	Email opendata@bfs.admin.ch — but only for portal-level matters (missing datasets, listing an application). The portal is a catalogue: dataset-specific reuse permission must be requested from the pu...
SVGW / SSIGE	Fachbereich Wasser (drinking water and water supply)	No individual names published for the water unit (SVGW)	wasser@svgw.ch info@svgw.ch	044 288 33 50 (	Email wasser@svgw.ch, reachable Mon–Fri 08:00–12:00 / 13:00–17:00; SVGW is an industry association, so ask whether the drinking-water statistics can be licensed and which member utilities own the un...

Outreach Notes by Agency

1. BAFU/FOEN — Abteilung Hydrologie.

Two separate channels matter. Bulk/historical data goes through the "Datenservice Hydrologie" order form, and the page explicitly says to fall back to hydrologie@bafu.admin.ch if you get no confirmation (BAFU).

Real-time/programmatic access (HTTP interface, LINDAS feed) is handled by the Abfragezentrale at abfragezentrale@bafu.admin.ch (hydrodata.ch). Write in German, state the stations and parameters, the time range, and the intended publication/reuse. Mention that deliveries have generally been free since 1 January 2020 but that high-effort requests are billed under the fee ordinance, so you can ask for a cost estimate up front (BAFU). For sensor questions, ask for Sektion Hydrometrie (Robert Lukes) (BAFU).

2. BAFU/FOEN — NAWA.

NAWA metadata lists both the Abteilung Wasser (wasser@bafu.admin.ch) and the Abteilung Hydrologie (hydrologie@bafu.admin.ch) as points of contact (geocat). Address the Sektion Gewässerqualität (Christian Leu) (FOEN). Because NAWA is run jointly with the cantons, phrase the request as "federal data plus permission to approach the cantonal station operators", and ask for the station-to-canton mapping (BAFU).

3. BAFU/FOEN — NAQUA.

Skip generic addresses: BAFU names a dedicated mailbox, hydrogeologie@bafu.admin.ch, for data from individual NAQUA sites including groundwater quantity, quality and isotopes (BAFU). List the site codes and parameters you need. The relevant section head is Flavio Malaguerra (Hydrogeologische Grundlagen) (BAFU). Note that many NAQUA sites are cantonally operated, so ask explicitly about onward-sharing rights.

4. MeteoSwiss.

There is a dedicated Open Data Support team (opendata.en@meteoswiss.ch, +41 58 460 99 99) registered as point of contact in MeteoSwiss geocat records (geocat). Since MeteoSwiss data is now open, frame the email around instrument metadata, station documentation and API/STAC usage rather than permission; use the web contact form if you prefer a tracked ticket (opendatadocs.meteoswiss.ch).

5. Swisstopo.

Standard geodata is free OGD with no registration, so do not ask for permission — ask a specific question. Use geodata@swisstopo.ch for non-OGD, historic or very large holdings and for licence clarifications (swisstopo). For technical questions about the data themselves, Raphaël Bovier in Datenabgabe was publicly designated as the specialist contact (admin.ch).

6. AWEL Zurich.

Zurich publishes named hydrometry staff, which is unusually convenient: email Miriam Steinmann (Projektleiterin Hydrometrie) or Marco Walser (Sektionsleiter Geoinformation und Hydrometrie) about the gauging network, sensors and data export; use gewaesserschutz@bd.zh.ch for water-quality/NAWA station data (Kanton Zürich, Kanton Zürich). German, short, with a one-line description of the intended reuse.

7. AWA Bern.

No hydrometry-specific mailbox is published, so send a single German email to info.awa@be.ch asking to be routed to the person responsible for "Hydrologische Daten" and the measuring network; the AWA's own page confirms it monitors water quality and regulates lake outflows (Kanton Bern). Jean-Pierre Clément and Reto Manser are the published Gewässerschutz contact persons and are reasonable cc recipients (KVU).

8. DGE Vaud.

Vaud maintains a complete per-domain staff list, so go straight to the right desk: Rafael Xavier Meriade Duarte for "Hydrologie et force hydraulique" (network and sensors), Stéphanie André as division head for formal data-reuse authorisation, and Florence Dapples (DGE-PRE) for water-quality/biology monitoring (État de Vaud). Write in French; cc info.dge@vd.ch so the request is registered by the office (KVU).

9. UCA Ticino.

The office publishes only a "Scrivici" web form plus the secretariat number, so use the form and address it to Capo ufficio Laurent Filippini (Ticino). Write in Italian, mention that you are asking about the water-course gauging/monitoring stations and about permission to reuse published series; offer a phone call on +41 91 814 26 81 (Ticino).

10. UPAAI Ticino.

Email dt-upai@ti.ch in Italian and cc Capo ufficio Mauro Veronesi (mauro.veronesi@ti.ch) (KVU, acqua360 PDF). Since much Ticino environmental data is already published via the OASI portal, name the specific OASI series and ask (a) the reuse licence and (b) which sensor models feed those series.

11. Aargau AfU.

The department's website routes contact through the staff directory rather than naming web contacts (Kanton Aargau). Email umwelt@ag.ch with a clear subject line ("Anfrage Messnetz Oberflächengewässer / Datennutzung") and cc Fachbereichsleiter Gewässerschutz Martin Märki; sections for surface water and for groundwater/geology are separate, so say which you mean (KVU).

12. uwe Luzern.

The Oberflächengewässer team directory maps roles exactly onto the two questions: Robert Lovas covers "Hydrometrie, Seesanieung" and Ursula Leuenberger covers "Datenhaltung, Grundwasserqualität" (Kanton Luzern). Individual emails are not published, so either phone them on their direct lines or submit the uwe contact form naming both people (Kanton Luzern). Note their part-time schedules listed in the directory when expecting a reply.

13. ALW/Amt für Umwelt Thurgau.

Split the request: Philemon Diggelmann (Leiter Wasserbau und Hydrometrie) for the gauging network, station equipment and hydrometric data; Heinz Ehmann (Leiter Gewässerqualität und -nutzung) for chemistry/biology series (Kanton Thurgau, Kanton Thurgau). Thurgau already runs an open-data portal, so position the note as confirming reuse terms rather than requesting a data dump.

14. AUE Basel-Stadt.

The AUE publishes a full staff table with per-topic responsibilities, so a named approach is expected: Markus Sommer (Fachstellenleiter Oberflächengewässer und Abwasser) is the primary contact, with Dr. Paul Svoboda as abteilungsleiter for escalation and Dr. Jürg Schulze for surface-water/fisheries biomonitoring (Kanton Basel-Stadt). Basel-Stadt also publishes on data.bs.ch, so mention which dataset you want to reuse.

15. Geneva OCEau.

Only service-level contacts are published. Email eau@etat.ge.ch in French, subject-lined for the SSPMA (Service de la surveillance et de la protection des eaux et des milieux aquatiques), and ask to be forwarded to the monitoring/measurement unit (État de Genève). If you need a decision on reuse rather than a technical answer, address the OCEau direction under Guillaume Pierrehumbert (État de Genève).

16. Eawag UWO.

This is a research network, so a normal scientific email works best. Frank Blumensaat is the corresponding author on the UWO sensor-network publications and the natural first contact for data access, licensing of the Fehraltorf dataset and co-authorship expectations (UWO LoRa mesh paper PDF). For hardware specifics — which sensors, which telemetry, maintenance regime — write to Christian Ebi, whose stated role is exactly wireless data transmission, sensor networks and measurement-system deployment (Eawag).

17. Eawag Datalakes.

The portal states the routing itself, so follow it literally: James Runnalls for anything about how the web application, API or data pipeline works, and Damien Bouffard for the project and possible collaborations — which is where reuse permission and joint-publication questions belong (Datalakes). Datalakes is explicitly built on FAIR open-data principles, which is a good framing for a reuse request.

18. Eawag Aquascope.

aquascope.ch has a "Get in Touch" section but publishes no email or form (aquascope.ch). Write instead to Francesco Pomati, listed as Aquascope PI on the Datalakes project register (Datalakes), and cc Christian Ebi for the imaging/sensor hardware (Aquascope team). Because the imagery is high-volume and processed with machine-learning pipelines, ask specifically for the processed data product and its licence rather than raw imagery. Press-type queries go to medien@eawag.ch (admin.ch).

19. WSL — NADUF / NAWA FRACHT.

Two-part approach. The programme is FOEN-led with Eawag and WSL as partners, and the metadata point of contact is BAFU Abteilung Hydrologie (INSPIRE/geocat); use hydrologie@bafu.admin.ch for the programme-level dataset. For the WSL-operated Alptal catchments, the WSL data page states that specialised data must be requested from the responsible researchers and names them, so email Luzi Bernhard (discharge/weather) and Patrick Schleppi (nutrient dynamics) at firstname.lastname@wsl.ch (WSL, WSL). Use the current programme name: NADUF was renamed NAWA FRACHT in 2025 (BAFU).

20. LéXPLORE.

The platform website invites project submissions and public visits but publishes no contact details (lexplore.info). Go to the operational manager: Natacha Tofield-Pasche, Operational Director of the EPFL Limnology Center, whose stated role covers platform exploitation, observational systems and the continuity/quality of the high-frequency dataset (EPFL people). Note that LéXPLORE provides a near-real-time background dataset to anyone interested, so ask about access terms to that core dataset first (lexplore.info). French or English both fine; Damien Bouffard at Eawag is the partner-side contact (Eawag).

21. api.existenz.ch.

A single-person, community-run service: the site invites feedback and help requests to cstuder@existenz.ch (api.existenz.ch). Keep it short and technical (rate limits, archive access via the Datasette/InfluxDB endpoints, station metadata). Important for permissions: the site states BAFU data must be credited and linked to BAFU, so upstream licence questions belong to BAFU, not to existenz.ch (api.existenz.ch).

22. opendata.swiss.

The published channel is opendata@bfs.admin.ch, and its stated purposes are having datasets added to the catalogue, listing applications that reuse the data, and onboarding an organisation as a publisher (opendata.swiss). It is not a rights-holder: use it for portal/harvesting issues and to register your reuse as an application, and take dataset-specific permission questions to the publishing office named in each record.

23. SVGW.

There is a dedicated water desk: wasser@svgw.ch / 044 288 33 50, staffed Mon–Fri 08:00–12:00 and 13:00–17:00 (SVGW). Because SVGW is an industry association of water, gas and heat utilities rather than a public authority, ask (a) whether the drinking-water/water-supply statistics can be licensed for your purpose, and (b) whether SVGW can broker contact with member utilities that operate sensors; if it turns into a publication matter, the AQUA & GAS editorial team is a separate route (aquaetgas.ch). German at the Zurich head office; Lausanne and Bellinzona branches cover French and Italian (SVGW).

Suggested Outreach Message

Data reuse

We are a small research team developing an open-source early warning system for river oxygen levels in Switzerland (AquaSentinel AI). We would like to understand whether [Agency]'s data may be used in our prototype, and under what conditions. Could you point us to the relevant data licence or data access process?

Sensor technology

We are evaluating sensor options for a new real-time river monitoring prototype. We would be grateful to learn more about the sensor types and measurement infrastructure [Agency] uses for [network name] — particularly for dissolved oxygen, temperature, and conductivity. Any published documentation or a brief conversation would be very helpful.